

Category	Excellent	Good	Adequate	Marginal	Inadequate
An assignment which falls under one of the above categories should satisfy the description detailed in this row.	Strong evidence of original thinking; good organization; capacity to analyze and synthesize; superior grasp of subject matter with sound critical evaluations	Evidence of grasp of subject matter, some evidence of critical capacity and analytic ability; reasonable understanding of relevant issues	Understanding of the subject matter and ability to develop solutions to simple problems in the material	Some evidence of familiarity with the subject matter and some evidence that critical and analytical skills have been developed	Little evidence of even superficial understanding of subject matter; weakness in critical and analytic skills
Part 0: Introduction [10]	10-9 Concise introduction that grabs readers attention Does not include jargon, or irrelevant information. States relevant information in a concise manner.	8-7 Introduction grabs the readers' attention, however, includes some seemingly irrelevant information. Important information is explained in a mostly concise manner	6-5 Introduction grabs the readers' attention but includes irrelevant information. Too long and overly verbose.	4-3 Introduction does not grab and the reader's attention. Introduction is slightly too long and includes seemingly irrelevant information	2-0 No proper introduction Introduction is too long and includes irrelevant/incorrect information for the assignment.
Part 1: Trend and Short-run Output calculation, description and countries comparison [20]	20-18 All data series are correctly calculated Correctly and precisely explains how to calculate all new constructed data series. Thoroughly compares Japan's data with the assigned country's, clearly explaining key differences and implications	17-15 Most data series are correctly calculated (1-2 errors) Correctly explains how to calculate most new constructed data series Explains main differences with some detail, though analysis may be brief or missing some depth	14-12 There are some notable errors in the data series calculations Explanations of how to calculate some new constructed series constructed are incorrect/unclear Identifies a few differences but lacks detail or clear connections	11-10 Most data series are incorrectly calculated There are many notable errors in the data series calculations Incorrectly explains how to calculate most, or all, new constructed series Differences are noted vaguely and lack supporting evidence or clarity	10-0 All data sources are incorrect The calculations for the data series are incorrect. Does not explain how to calculate the constructed series Fails to discuss or accurately address differences in the data between the two countries
Part 2: Highlight One of the causes of the Japan's Lost Decades [25]	25-23 Thoroughly analyzes a chosen cause of Japan's Lost Decades Effectively applies the Growth or IS-MP model Strongly connects insights to Part 0 and 1	22-20 Explains a cause with reasonable depth References a chosen model appropriately Links findings to Part 1	19-16 Identifies a cause and mentions a model Offers limited detail or clarity Has a partial connection to Part 1	15-13 Provides only a cursory mention of a cause Misapplies or barely applies the model Barely references Part 1	12-0 Fails to discuss a clear cause or model Does not connect to Part 1 Omits supporting evidence entirely
Part 3: Lessons Learned and Policy Recommendations [10]	10-9 Clearly derives a key lesson from Part 2's findings Offers a well-reasoned policy recommendation for Canada Effectively highlights relevant parallels between Canada and Japan Maintains strong clarity and connection to prior analysis	8-7 Identifies a lesson based on Part 2 Proposes a reasonable policy idea for Canada Briefly notes parallels between Canada and Japan Demonstrates decent clarity and linkage to earlier content	6-5 States a general lesson but lacks detail Provides a basic policy suggestion with limited reasoning Mentions possible parallels but doesn't explore them in depth Shows some connection to earlier parts, though inconsistently	4-3 Offers a weak or unclear lesson from Part 2 Suggests a vague or incomplete policy idea Makes little or no reference to parallels between countries Demonstrates minimal coherence with previous sections	2-0 Fails to draw a lesson from Part 2 Omits or completely misunderstands policy recommendations Neglects any mention of Canada-Japan parallels Lacks logical connection to earlier discussion
Structure, Style, and Flow [25]	25-23 Paragraphs are well organized by thought and flow logically Paragraphs transition smoothly between ideas Sentences are clear, easy to read and do not run on Writing is concise (each sentence has a purpose) The length is reasonable (800-1400 words) Economic concepts are explained in a manner that can be understood by non-experts Consistent and complete references	22-20 Most paragraphs are well organized by thought and flow logically Most paragraphs transition smoothly between ideas Most sentences are clear, easy to read and do not run on Most writing is concise (most sentences have a purpose) The length is reasonable (800-1400 words) Economic concepts are mostly explained in a manner that can be understood by non-experts Complete references but small inconsistencies	19-16 Paragraph organization and flow needs work Paragraphs do not always clearly connect ideas Reasoning and logic are sometimes unclear due to sentence structure and organization The length is acceptably shorter or longer than 800-1400 words Economic concepts are sometimes explained in a manner that can be understood by non-experts Complete references, but inconsistent format	15-13 Poor paragraph organization and flow Sentence structure and/or word choice and/or grammar makes it difficult to understand reasoning Too many lengthy quotations The length is acceptably shorter or longer than 800-1400 words Economic concepts are seldomly explained in a manner that can be understood by nonexperts Missing some references, inconsistent format	12-0 Significant sentence structure and/or word choice and/or grammar errors makes it difficult to understand reasoning Not completely written in words and paragraphs (bullet points, equations, graphs) The length is too short or too long Economic concepts are not explained in a manner that can be understood by non-experts No references provided (-15 points)
Figures [10]	10-9 Every figure has a clear title to elicit which series are displayed. An clear and effective legend is included for figures with more than 1 data series. Units for all Figures are correctly and clearly labelled. All axes are correctly scaled	8-7 Most figures have a clear title to elicit the series that are displayed. A legend is included for figures when more than 1 data series is present. Units for most figures are correctly and clearly labelled. 1-2 Axes on the figures could be rescaled to better elicit the series' trend.	6-5 Some figures have a title to describe which series are displayed. A legend is missing for in some figures with more than 1 data series. The included legends may be unclear. Units for some figures are correctly and clearly labelled. Axes are properly scaled on some figures, though the scale on most trends	4-3 Figures do not include title and it is unclear which series are displayed. Legends are unclear or are omitted from figures with more than 1 data series. Numerous instances where labels are missing/unclear. Axes on figures are not properly scaled	2-0 Figures are missing sufficient labeling to be discerned.